

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 5 3

♥ K 9

♦ 9 6 3

♣ J 10 4

♠ A J 6

♥ Q 7 3

♦ Q 8 5 2

♣ 7 6 2



♠ 8 4 2

♥ A J 10 6 4

♦ K J 10

♣ 5 3

♠ K 10

♥ 8 5 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ A K Q 9 8

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

Assuming the ♣s behave you need to get one more winner. It's possible you could lead toward dummy's ♦Q but even if it works they would probably attack ♥s. Your best chance of getting an extra trick lies in the ♠ suit.

It is almost certain that West holds the ♠Q. Of course defenders sometimes don't lead according to the guidelines, but if East had the ♠Q he would likely have played it at the first trick. In addition, the Rule of 11 tells you there were 6 cards in the North, East and South hands higher than the ♠5. You can account for all of them, so West must have the ♠Q. In that case you can assure the contract by winning the first trick with the ♠K rather than the ♠10. In this way you will be able to gain a trick by finessing West for the ♠Q. It's true that if you won with the ♠10 you would still have both the ♠K and ♠A remaining, but you wouldn't have the dummy entry you needed.

With the unfortunate placement of red cards the only way you can enjoy 3 ♠ tricks is to take your ♠K on the first trick and later finesse West for the ♠Q.

Notice how strange this game can be. If your holding was ♠ K 2 rather than ♠ K 10 you would have had no difficulty coming up with the correct play. But the fact that you can win a cheap trick with the ♠10 tries to lure you into making an inferior play.

With a balanced, 17 point hand you open 1NT. Partner responds 2NT.

You were invited to bid 3NT if you have a maximum opener. With 17 points you accept the invitation.

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠5. You put on dummy's ♠6 and East plays the ♠8.

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Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 5 : Total = 8

The good news is that they didn't lead a ♥. The bad news is that if you give up the lead they probably will.

Board 3
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ J 10 2
 ♥ J 8 5 4
 ♦ 10 9 8
 ♣ K 9 4

♠ 9 6 4
 ♥ K 6 2
 ♦ Q 6 2
 ♣ J 7 5 3



♠ 8 7
 ♥ 10 9
 ♦ A K J 7 3
 ♣ Q 10 6 2

♠ A K Q 5 3
 ♥ A Q 7 3
 ♦ 5 4
 ♣ A 8

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
 evenly to give you a fourth ♥ trick. In fact, there is a chance that you might ruff the fourth ♥.

Play exactly two rounds of trumps with the ♠A and ♠K. Then play ♥K, ♥A and ♥Q. If both defenders follow to three leads your fourth ♥ is good so you pull the last trump. If somebody shows out on the third lead and does not ruff then play your last ♥ and ruff in dummy. Return to your hand with the ♣A and pull trumps.

You will always make the contract when ♥s split 3-3.

By pulling exactly 2 rounds of trumps first you can also succeed in the case where ♥s split 4-2 and the defender with the doubleton ♥ also has a doubleton trump.

You have a nice hand, but can only open 1 ♠.

Partner raises to 2 ♠.

Partner has 6-10 points, you have 20 points.

The math works so you bid 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ 10, you cover and East plays the three high ♦s.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

To start with, you ruff the third ♦. You cannot avoid the ♣ loser, so you might think that ♥s must break